



News Release

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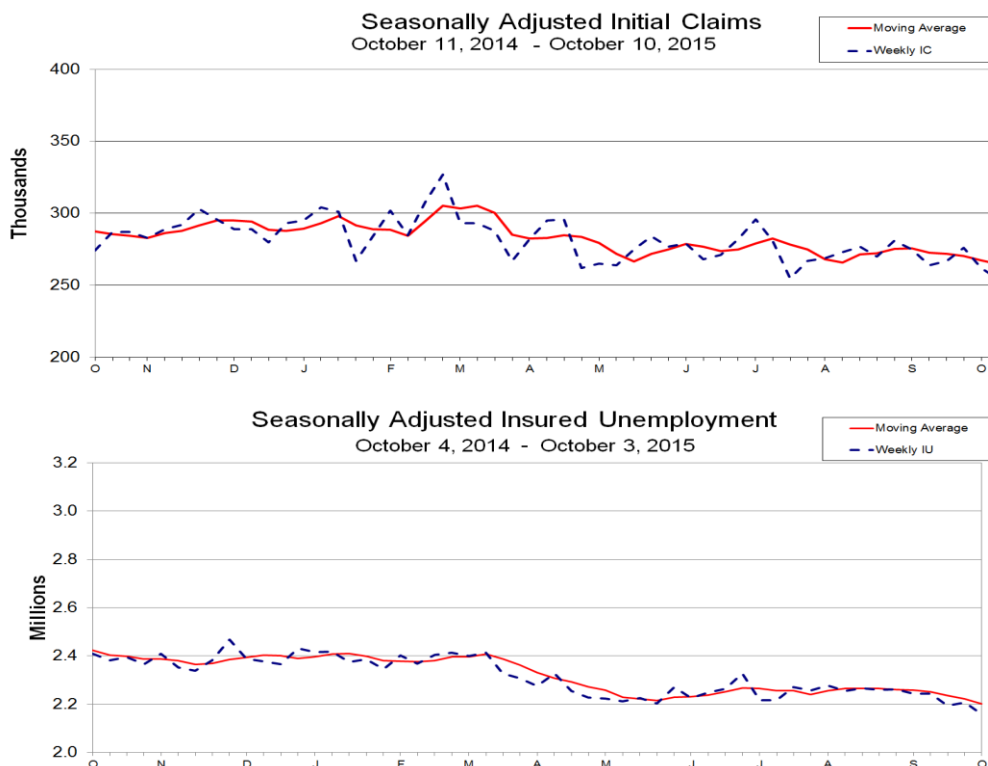
UNEMPLOYMENT INSURANCE WEEKLY CLAIMS

SEASONALLY ADJUSTED DATA

In the week ending October 10, the advance figure for seasonally adjusted **initial claims** was 255,000, a decrease of 7,000 from the previous week's revised level. The previous week's level was revised down by 1,000 from 263,000 to 262,000. The 4-week moving average was 265,000, a decrease of 2,250 from the previous week's revised average. This is the lowest level for this average since December 15, 1973 when it was 256,750. The previous week's average was revised down by 250 from 267,500 to 267,250.

There were no special factors impacting this week's initial claims.

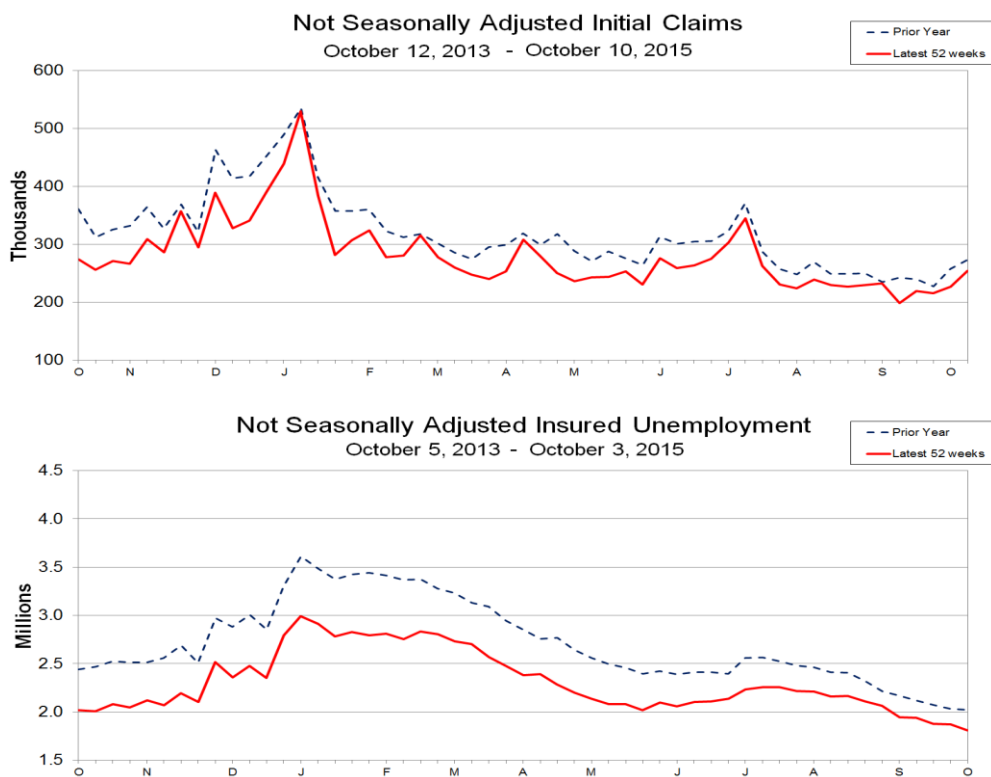
The advance seasonally adjusted **insured unemployment rate** was 1.6 percent for the week ending October 3, unchanged from the previous week's unrevised rate. The advance number for seasonally adjusted **insured unemployment** during the week ending October 3 was 2,158,000, a decrease of 50,000 from the previous week's revised level. This is the lowest level for insured unemployment since November 4, 2000 when it was 2,110,000. The previous week's level was revised up 4,000 from 2,204,000 to 2,208,000. The 4-week moving average was 2,201,250, a decrease of 21,250 from the previous week's revised average. This is the lowest level for this average since November 18, 2000 when it was 2,169,000. The previous week's average was revised up by 1,000 from 2,221,500 to 2,222,500.



UNADJUSTED DATA

The advance number of actual initial claims under state programs, unadjusted, totaled 255,059 in the week ending October 10, an increase of 27,883 (or 12.3 percent) from the previous week. The seasonal factors had expected an increase of 35,373 (or 15.6 percent) from the previous week. There were 273,756 initial claims in the comparable week in 2014.

The advance unadjusted insured unemployment rate was 1.3 percent during the week ending October 3, a decrease of 0.1 percentage point from the prior week. The advance unadjusted number for persons claiming UI benefits in state programs totaled 1,810,787, a decrease of 59,588 (or -3.2 percent) from the preceding week. The seasonal factors had expected a decrease of 17,666 (or -0.9 percent) from the previous week. A year earlier the rate was 1.5 percent and the volume was 2,018,858.



The total number of people claiming benefits in all programs for the week ending September 26 was 1,916,239, a decrease of 7,496 from the previous week. There were 2,088,591 persons claiming benefits in all programs in the comparable week in 2014.

No state was triggered "on" the Extended Benefits program during the week ending September 26.

Initial claims for UI benefits filed by former Federal civilian employees totaled 2,036 in the week ending October 3, an increase of 1,095 from the prior week. There were 1,484 initial claims filed by newly discharged veterans, an increase of 220 from the preceding week.

There were 11,112 former Federal civilian employees claiming UI benefits for the week ending September 26, a decrease of 413 from the previous week. Newly discharged veterans claiming benefits totaled 17,706, a decrease of 65 from the prior week.

The highest insured unemployment rates in the week ending September 26 were in Puerto Rico (3.4), the Virgin Islands (2.9), Alaska (2.5), New Jersey (2.3), Nevada (2.2), California (2.1), Pennsylvania (2.1), Connecticut (2.0), Illinois (1.8), and West Virginia (1.8).

The largest increases in initial claims for the week ending October 3 were in Pennsylvania (+2,548), California (+2,351), Texas (+1,323), Georgia (+1,235), and Arizona (+722), while the largest decreases were in Michigan (-2,436), New York (-1,614), Nevada (-439), Puerto Rico (-242), and Oregon (-172).

UNEMPLOYMENT INSURANCE DATA FOR REGULAR STATE PROGRAMS

WEEK ENDING	October 10	October 3	Change	September 26	Prior Year¹
Initial Claims (SA)	255,000	262,000	-7,000	276,000	274,000
Initial Claims (NSA)	255,059	227,176	+27,883	215,116	273,756
4-Wk Moving Average (SA)	265,000	267,250	-2,250	270,500	287,500
WEEK ENDING	October 3	September 26	Change	September 19	Prior Year¹
Insured Unemployment (SA)	2,158,000	2,208,000	-50,000	2,195,000	2,409,000
Insured Unemployment (NSA)	1,810,787	1,870,375	-59,588	1,876,958	2,018,858
4-Wk Moving Average (SA)	2,201,250	2,222,500	-21,250	2,236,250	2,423,500
Insured Unemployment Rate (SA)²	1.6%	1.6%	0.0	1.6%	1.8%
Insured Unemployment Rate (NSA)²	1.3%	1.4%	-0.1	1.4%	1.5%

INITIAL CLAIMS FILED IN FEDERAL PROGRAMS (UNADJUSTED)

WEEK ENDING	October 3	September 26	Change	Prior Year¹
Federal Employees (UCFE)	2,036	941	+1,095	1,541
Newly Discharged Veterans (UCX)	1,484	1,264	+220	2,598

PERSONS CLAIMING UI BENEFITS IN ALL PROGRAMS (UNADJUSTED)

WEEK ENDING	September 26	September 19	Change	Prior Year¹
Regular State	1,866,282	1,872,468	-6,186	2,027,438
Federal Employees	11,112	11,525	-413	16,005
Newly Discharged Veterans	17,706	17,771	-65	24,843
Extended Benefits³	0	0	0	5
State Additional Benefits⁴	7,215	6,997	+218	5,288
STC / Workshare⁵	13,924	14,974	-1,050	15,012
TOTAL	1,916,239	1,923,735	-7,496	2,088,591

FOOTNOTES

SA - Seasonally Adjusted Data, NSA - Not Seasonally Adjusted Data

1. Prior year is comparable to most recent data.
2. Most recent week used covered employment of 135,574,808 as denominator.
3. Information on the EB program can be found here: [EB Program information](#)
4. Some states maintain additional benefit programs for those claimants who exhaust regular, extended and emergency benefits. Information on states that participate, and the extent of benefits paid, can be found starting on page 4-5 of this link: [Extensions and Special Programs PDF](#)
5. Information on STC/Worksharing can be found starting on page 4-9 of the following link: [Extensions and Special Programs PDF](#)

Advance State Claims - Not Seasonally Adjusted

STATE	Initial Claims Filed During Week Ended October 10			Insured Unemployment For Week Ended October 3		
	Advance	Prior Wk	Change	Advance	Prior Wk	Change
Alabama	3,247	2,809	438	19,845	20,613	-768
Alaska	2,179	1,238	941	7,440	7,980	-540
Arizona	4,088	4,161	-73	28,358	32,529	-4,171
Arkansas	2,730	2,351	379	17,121	18,299	-1,178
California	44,620	42,531	2,089	319,611	329,972	-10,361
Colorado	2,976	2,834	142	24,967	24,683	284
Connecticut	3,305	2,957	348	33,302	32,668	634
Delaware	795	659	136	5,606	5,680	-74
District of Columbia	754	362	392	7,618	8,157	-539
Florida	9,286	8,209	1,077	52,161	63,176	-11,015
Georgia	8,260	6,881	1,379	35,388	35,765	-377
Hawaii	1,191	1,110	81	6,789	6,844	-55
Idaho	1,136	962	174	4,873	5,697	-824
Illinois	10,616	9,298	1,318	97,251	100,170	-2,919
Indiana	3,702	3,139	563	20,222	20,289	-67
Iowa	2,602	2,141	461	16,877	16,092	785
Kansas	2,010	1,691	319	11,899	12,748	-849
Kentucky	2,694	2,808	-114	18,387	19,698	-1,311
Louisiana	2,317	2,341	-24	21,977	23,097	-1,120
Maine	613	703	-90	4,322	4,519	-197
Maryland	3,777	3,684	93	31,200	34,520	-3,320
Massachusetts	5,009	4,944	65	55,451	56,297	-846
Michigan	7,020	5,651	1,369	43,189	43,834	-645
Minnesota	3,358	3,050	308	29,215	27,925	1,290
Mississippi	1,579	1,495	84	10,616	12,044	-1,428
Missouri	4,521	3,910	611	23,912	27,292	-3,380
Montana	1,296	1,187	109	4,736	4,947	-211
Nebraska	854	1,120	-266	5,278	4,840	438
Nevada	3,251	2,246	1,005	21,958	25,469	-3,511
New Hampshire	540	499	41	3,792	4,077	-285
New Jersey	8,281	8,435	-154	86,121	88,062	-1,941
New Mexico	1,246	1,150	96	10,827	11,287	-460
New York	17,418	14,988	2,430	136,804	136,658	146
North Carolina	4,222	3,942	280	26,929	28,239	-1,310
North Dakota	760	339	421	4,927	2,322	2,605
Ohio	6,648	6,833	-185	48,927	49,005	-78
Oklahoma	2,158	1,830	328	20,111	20,680	-569
Oregon	4,323	3,860	463	26,249	26,446	-197
Pennsylvania	18,116	15,891	2,225	111,493	114,042	-2,549
Puerto Rico	2,519	1,720	799	28,133	29,922	-1,789
Rhode Island	1,020	844	176	6,937	6,842	95
South Carolina	3,420	2,465	955	14,132	15,219	-1,087
South Dakota	205	192	13	938	938	
Tennessee	3,448	2,971	477	21,321	22,179	-858
Texas	19,175	16,483	2,692	155,947	163,862	-7,915
Utah	1,388	1,130	258	7,642	8,334	-692
Vermont	430	352	78	2,846	2,675	171
Virgin Islands	57	45	12	1,114	1,074	40
Virginia	3,382	3,540	-158	26,846	24,991	1,855
Washington	8,330	6,453	1,877	42,730	41,902	828
West Virginia	1,595	988	607	13,294	12,252	1,042
Wisconsin	6,132	5,287	845	29,620	29,873	-253
Wyoming	460	467	-7	3,538	3,650	-112
US Total	255,059	227,176	27,883	1,810,787	1,870,375	-59,588

Note: Advance Claims are not directly comparable to claims reported in prior weeks. Advance claims are reported by the state liable for paying the unemployment compensation, whereas previous weeks reported reflect claimants by state of residence. In addition, claims reported as "workshare equivalent" in the previous week are added to the advance claims as a proxy for the current week's "workshare equivalent" activity.

Seasonally Adjusted US Weekly UI Claims (in thousands)

Week Ending	Change from			Insured Unemployment	Change from		IUR
	Initial Claims	Prior Week	4-Week Average		Prior Week	4-Week Average	
October 4, 2014	289	-3	291.25	2,409	5	2,423.50	1.8
October 11, 2014	274	-15	287.50	2,383	-26	2,404.25	1.8
October 18, 2014	287	13	285.50	2,395	12	2,397.75	1.8
October 25, 2014	287	0	284.25	2,365	-30	2,388.00	1.8
November 1, 2014	283	-4	282.75	2,408	43	2,387.75	1.8
November 8, 2014	289	6	286.50	2,352	-56	2,380.00	1.8
November 15, 2014	292	3	287.75	2,339	-13	2,366.00	1.8
November 22, 2014	303	11	291.75	2,383	44	2,370.50	1.8
November 29, 2014	296	-7	295.00	2,469	86	2,385.75	1.9
December 6, 2014	289	-7	295.00	2,388	-81	2,394.75	1.8
December 13, 2014	289	0	294.25	2,377	-11	2,404.25	1.8
December 20, 2014	280	-9	288.50	2,366	-11	2,400.00	1.8
December 27, 2014	293	13	287.75	2,431	65	2,390.50	1.8
January 3, 2015	295	2	289.25	2,415	-16	2,397.25	1.8
January 10, 2015	304	9	293.00	2,418	3	2,407.50	1.8
January 17, 2015	301	-3	298.25	2,376	-42	2,410.00	1.8
January 24, 2015	267	-34	291.75	2,386	10	2,398.75	1.8
January 31, 2015	284	17	289.00	2,346	-40	2,381.50	1.8
February 7, 2015	302	18	288.50	2,402	56	2,377.50	1.8
February 14, 2015	285	-17	284.50	2,369	-33	2,375.75	1.8
February 21, 2015	308	23	294.75	2,405	36	2,380.50	1.8
February 28, 2015	327	19	305.50	2,414	9	2,397.50	1.8
March 7, 2015	293	-34	303.25	2,399	-15	2,396.75	1.8
March 14, 2015	293	0	305.25	2,413	14	2,407.75	1.8
March 21, 2015	288	-5	300.25	2,327	-86	2,388.25	1.7
March 28, 2015	267	-21	285.25	2,308	-19	2,361.75	1.7
April 4, 2015	282	15	282.50	2,275	-33	2,330.75	1.7
April 11, 2015	295	13	283.00	2,327	52	2,309.25	1.7
April 18, 2015	296	1	285.00	2,256	-71	2,291.50	1.7
April 25, 2015	262	-34	283.75	2,229	-27	2,271.75	1.7
May 2, 2015	265	3	279.50	2,223	-6	2,258.75	1.7
May 9, 2015	264	-1	271.75	2,212	-11	2,230.00	1.6
May 16, 2015	275	11	266.50	2,226	14	2,222.50	1.7
May 23, 2015	284	9	272.00	2,204	-22	2,216.25	1.6
May 30, 2015	277	-7	275.00	2,272	68	2,228.50	1.7
June 6, 2015	279	2	278.75	2,225	-47	2,231.75	1.7
June 13, 2015	268	-11	277.00	2,249	24	2,237.50	1.7
June 20, 2015	271	3	273.75	2,265	16	2,252.75	1.7
June 27, 2015	282	11	275.00	2,327	62	2,266.50	1.7
July 4, 2015	296	14	279.25	2,216	-111	2,264.25	1.6
July 11, 2015	281	-15	282.50	2,216	0	2,256.00	1.6
July 18, 2015	255	-26	278.50	2,270	54	2,257.25	1.7
July 25, 2015	267	12	274.75	2,258	-12	2,240.00	1.7
August 1, 2015	269	2	268.00	2,278	20	2,255.50	1.7
August 8, 2015	273	4	266.00	2,256	-22	2,265.50	1.7
August 15, 2015	277	4	271.50	2,266	10	2,264.50	1.7
August 22, 2015	270	-7	272.25	2,259	-7	2,264.75	1.7
August 29, 2015	281	11	275.25	2,263	4	2,261.00	1.7
September 5, 2015	275	-6	275.75	2,243	-20	2,257.75	1.7
September 12, 2015	264	-11	272.50	2,244	1	2,252.25	1.7
September 19, 2015	267	3	271.75	2,195	-49	2,236.25	1.6
September 26, 2015	276	9	270.50	2,208	13	2,222.50	1.6
October 3, 2015	262	-14	267.25	2,158	-50	2,201.25	1.6
October 10, 2015	255	-7	265.00				

Initial Claims Filed During Week Ended October 3								Insured Unemployment For Week Ended September 26				
INITIAL CLAIMS								INSURED UNEMPLOYMENT				
STATE	STATE	CHANGE FROM				STATE	CHANGE FROM				ALL PROGRAMS EXCLUDING RAILROAD RETIREMENT	
		LAST WEEK	YEAR AGO	UCFE ¹	UCX ¹		LAST WEEK	YEAR AGO	UCFE ¹	UCX ¹		
Alabama	2809	375	-321	18	24	20613	1.1	-323	-3281	91	173	20877
Alaska	1238	53	-126	13	0	7980	2.5	644	-967	89	37	8106
Arizona	4161	722	-294	25	13	32529	1.3	-416	-3025	136	192	32857
Arkansas	2351	193	-565	10	11	18299	1.6	-248	-1183	95	149	18543
California	42531	2351	-3412	451	219	329972	2.1	-6692	-20678	2100	3534	335606
Colorado	2834	628	-89	30	61	24683	1.0	-82	-1673	167	709	25559
Connecticut	2957	600	-309	13	16	32668	2.0	-320	-5616	84	166	32918
Delaware	659	87	-19	4	4	5680	1.4	530	-898	16	22	5718
District of Columbia	362	104	-37	13	2	8157	1.5	-121	-1287	348	18	8523
Florida	8209	497	-6171	31	73	63176	0.8	1219	-21050	243	410	63829
Georgia	6881	1235	-943	109	65	35765	0.9	439	-5684	265	596	36626
Hawaii	1110	81	-333	5	30	6844	1.2	47	-1894	99	171	7114
Idaho	962	28	-213	2	6	5697	0.9	135	-1356	25	38	5760
Illinois	9298	-125	-389	11	19	100170	1.8	1914	-5381	366	487	101023
Indiana	3139	105	-844	11	17	20289	0.7	-518	-3231	120	121	20530
Iowa	2141	-132	-1359	6	3	16092	1.1	-542	821	56	82	16230
Kansas	1691	218	-634	5	6	12748	1.0	-197	-1058	67	140	12955
Kentucky	2808	599	-422	61	4	19698	1.1	496	-1995	335	297	20330
Louisiana	2341	-1	260	3	11	23097	1.2	-260	3883	43	86	23226
Maine	703	101	-150	4	3	4519	0.8	-180	-1623	25	29	4573
Maryland	3684	527	-270	36	20	34520	1.4	-328	-9286	359	291	35170
Massachusetts	4944	455	-940	143	24	56297	1.7	-64	-10435	209	340	56846
Michigan	5651	-2436	-811	24	29	43834	1.1	270	-8189	121	246	44201
Minnesota	3050	247	-372	6	15	27925	1.0	-437	-822	79	180	28184
Mississippi	1495	37	-313	7	5	12044	1.1	-306	-3612	62	58	12164
Missouri	3910	-90	-811	178	13	27292	1.0	-173	-4345	705	143	28140
Montana	1187	305	39	16	7	4947	1.2	41	-194	39	57	5043
Nebraska	1120	392	93	3	2	4840	0.5	-273	-998	30	25	4895
Nevada	2246	-439	-774	8	9	25469	2.2	-180	1624	80	192	25741
New Hampshire	499	20	-203	1	2	4077	0.7	-74	-1185	4	9	4090
New Jersey	8435	511	-748	24	32	88062	2.3	267	-16362	244	522	88828
New Mexico	1150	38	62	30	6	11287	1.5	288	-1143	95	92	11474
New York	14988	-1614	-4956	47	48	136658	1.6	-2208	-19567	612	888	138158
North Carolina	3942	432	-892	8	53	28239	0.7	-433	-15826	130	401	28770
North Dakota	339	-22	-95	2	0	2322	0.5	-206	1227	10	7	2339
Ohio	6833	612	-965	22	49	49005	1.0	-2175	-2562	225	438	49668
Oklahoma	1830	119	404	7	13	20680	1.3	-139	5942	75	168	20923
Oregon	3860	-172	-1312	21	27	26446	1.6	-383	-3334	179	300	26925
Pennsylvania	15891	2548	1271	258	85	114042	2.1	2451	-3395	585	597	115224
Puerto Rico	1720	-242	-268	2	6	29922	3.4	1533	-1929	129	255	30306
Rhode Island	844	167	-177	4	1	6842	1.5	-30	-1404	24	55	6921
South Carolina	2465	120	-606	12	15	15219	0.8	-248	-1914	43	131	15393
South Dakota	192	18	-18	2	0	938	0.2	-83	-121	22	4	964
Tennessee	2971	-50	-629	141	14	22179	0.8	-647	-5245	138	201	22518
Texas	16483	1323	2001	104	270	163862	1.5	2756	32881	1009	2698	167569
Utah	1130	115	-130	50	5	8334	0.7	-164	-731	378	55	8767
Vermont	352	66	-48	2	1	2675	0.9	-95	-543	17	15	2707
Virgin Islands	45	-21	-13	0	0	1074	2.9	-36	-70	4	6	1084
Virginia	3540	630	-536	18	28	24991	0.7	-424	-5973	283	670	25944
Washington	6453	423	-637	24	98	41902	1.4	-234	-2603	296	1007	43205
West Virginia	988	53	-83	4	6	12252	1.8	-152	1620	65	82	12399
Wisconsin	5287	228	-1378	3	11	29873	1.1	-190	-7032	83	86	30042
Wyoming	467	41	116	4	3	3650	1.3	-32	1326	8	30	3688
Totals	227176	12060	-30369	2036	1484	1870375	1.4	-6583	-161376	11112	17706	1899193

Figures Appearing In columns showing Over-The-Week Changes reflect all revisions in data for prior week submitted by State agencies.

1. The Unemployment Compensation program for Federal Employees (UCFE) and the Unemployment Compensation for Ex-servicemembers (UCX) exclude claims filed jointly under other programs to avoid duplication.
2. Rate is not seasonally adjusted. The source of US total covered employment is BLS.

UNADJUSTED INITIAL CLAIMS FOR WEEK ENDED OCTOBER 3, 2015

STATES WITH AN INCREASE OF MORE THAN 1,000

State	Change	State Supplied Comment
PA	+2,548	Layoffs in the construction, accommodation and food service, and administrative and support and waste management and remediation service industries.
CA	+2,351	Layoffs in the agriculture, forestry, fishing, and hunting industry.
TX	+1,323	Layoffs in the manufacturing, administrative and support and waste management and remediation service, transportation, and retail industries.
GA	+1,235	Layoffs in the manufacturing, administrative and support and waste management and remediation service, construction, and trade industries.

STATES WITH A DECREASE OF MORE THAN 1,000

State	Change	State Supplied Comment
MI	-2,436	Fewer layoffs in the manufacturing industry.
NY	-1,614	Fewer layoffs in the transportation and warehousing, accommodation and food service, and health care and social assistance industries.

TECHNICAL NOTES

This news release presents the weekly unemployment insurance (UI) claims reported by each state's unemployment insurance program offices. These claims may be used for monitoring workload volume, assessing state program operations and for assessing labor market conditions. States initially report claims directly taken by the state liable for the benefit payments, regardless of where the claimant who filed the claim resided. These are the basis for the advance initial claims and continued claims reported each week. These data come from ETA 538, Advance Weekly Initial and Continued Claims Report. The following week initial claims and continued claims are revised based on a second reporting by states that reflect the claimants by state of residence. These data come from the ETA 539, Weekly Claims and Extended Benefits Trigger Data Report.

A. Initial Claims

An initial claim is a claim filed by an unemployed individual after a separation from an employer. The claimant requests a determination of basic eligibility for the UI program. When an initial claim is filed with a state, certain programmatic activities take place and these result in activity counts including the count of initial claims. The count of U.S. initial claims for unemployment insurance is a leading economic indicator because it is an indication of emerging labor market conditions in the country. However, these are weekly administrative data which are difficult to seasonally adjust, making the series subject to some volatility.

B. Continued Weeks Claimed

A person who has already filed an initial claim and who has experienced a week of unemployment then files a continued claim to claim benefits for that week of unemployment. Continued claims are also referred to as insured unemployment. The count of U.S. continued weeks claimed is also a good indicator of labor market conditions. Continued claims reflect the current number of insured unemployed workers filing for UI benefits in the nation. While continued claims are not a leading indicator (they roughly coincide with economic cycles at their peaks and lag at cycle troughs), they provide confirming evidence of the direction of the U.S. economy.

C. Seasonal Adjustments and Annual Revisions

Over the course of a year, the weekly changes in the levels of initial claims and continued claims undergo regularly occurring fluctuations. These fluctuations may result from seasonal changes in weather, major holidays, the opening and closing of schools, or other similar events. Because these seasonal events follow a more or less regular pattern each year, their influence on the level of a series can be tempered by adjusting for regular seasonal variation. These adjustments make trend and cycle developments easier to spot. At the beginning of each calendar year, the Bureau of Labor Statistics provides the Employment and Training Administration (ETA) with a set of seasonal factors to apply to the unadjusted data during that year. Concurrent with the implementation and release of the new seasonal factors, ETA incorporates revisions to the UI claims historical series caused by updates to the unadjusted data.

[Weekly Claims Archives](#) [Weekly Claims Data](#)

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